7.8. Summary

CoffeeScript not only simplifies JavaScript's core syntax but also provides some syntactic sugar that can make programs easier to understand. Spread and rest parameters and destructuring provide the means to write concise expressions where long and confusing expressions (and statements) would otherwise be required. The syntax changes that CoffeeScript makes to JavaScript make programming more expressive and succinct.

Although CoffeeScript changes JavaScript's syntax dramatically, it makes only very small changes to JavaScript's semantics. You saw how to make the most natural use of CoffeeScript's dynamic types by learning to use duck typing.

Finally, succinctness of expression is a trade-off, and there is some potential for ambiguity in CoffeeScript. You learned how comprehensions and significant white-space can be clarified and looked closely at how the common technique of fluent interfaces can be applied in CoffeeScript programs.

Moving on, as expressive and succinct as CoffeeScript is, the syntax and semantics of CoffeeScript have been decided for you. To have full control over the expressive power of the language you use, you need to be able to manipulate the language itself—you need metaprogramming, and that's exactly what the next chapter is about.